Afterword

Writing this book—and keeping it up to date—has been a humbling experience. It has taken far longer than I had predicted or than I would like to admit. And, of course, it's not finished yet. Despite my best efforts and those of the technical reviewers, editors, and many other talented folks, a book this size is bound to contain errors, omissions, and passages that are less clear than they might be. Do let us know if you happen across any of these things; you can view and submit errata through the book's catalog page. Subsequent editions will incorporate changes sent in by readers just like you!

It has been said that you don't really know something until you've taught it. I have found this true of lecturing, and I find it equally true of writing.

I tell my students that when Java was very young, it was possible for one person to study hard and know almost everything about it. After a release or two, this was no longer true. Today, nobody in their right mind would seriously claim to "know all about Java"—if they do, it should cause your bogosity detector to go off at full volume. And the amount you need to know keeps growing. How can you keep up? Java books? Java magazines? Java courses? Conferences? There is no single answer; all of these are useful to some people. Oracle and others have programs that you should be aware of:

- For many years, JavaOne was the dominant conference on Java, put on by Sun Microsystems and briefly by Oracle, then shuttered for a few years. Recently, Oracle has folded this into CloudWorld, the annual Oracle conference. More recently, Oracle announced that JavaOne would be making a comeback in March 2025 in California. Visit the JavaOne website for the latest on this.
- There is a sporadically updated list of Java converences at JavaConferences.org.
- The Oracle Java Technology Network is a free web-based service for getting the latest APIs, news, and views.
- Over Java's lifetime, the publishing industry has changed a lot. There used to be several Java-related magazines published in print, some of whose articles would appear on the web. Today there are, so far as I know, no print magazines dedicated to Java. Oracle until recently (2023) published the online-only *Java Magazine* every month with technical articles on many aspects of Java written by professionals in tech who were also good writers (immodest to say that, as I was one of those writers); see the

magazine's website to view past issues. Now they are using Oracle staff for many articles, and "accepting" community-contributed articles.

- The Java Community Process is the home of Java standardization and enhancement.
- The OpenJDK community maintains and builds the open source version of the "official" JDK.
- O'Reilly books and conferences are among the very best available!
- I keep my own list of Java resources that I update sporadically, on my Java site; follow the link to my Java Resources List.
- A good source of Java news is Ken Kousen's Tales from the Jar Side newsletter.
- Some very interesting advanced topic discussions show up in Heinz Kabutz's Java Specialists' Newsletter.

There is no end of Java APIs to learn about. And there are still more books to be written . . . and read.

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